

KUMPULAN WANG SIMPANAN PEKERJA

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

INTELLIGENT DOCUMENT PROCESSING (IDP)

Prepared By
Digital Enterprise Solutions Department
EPF

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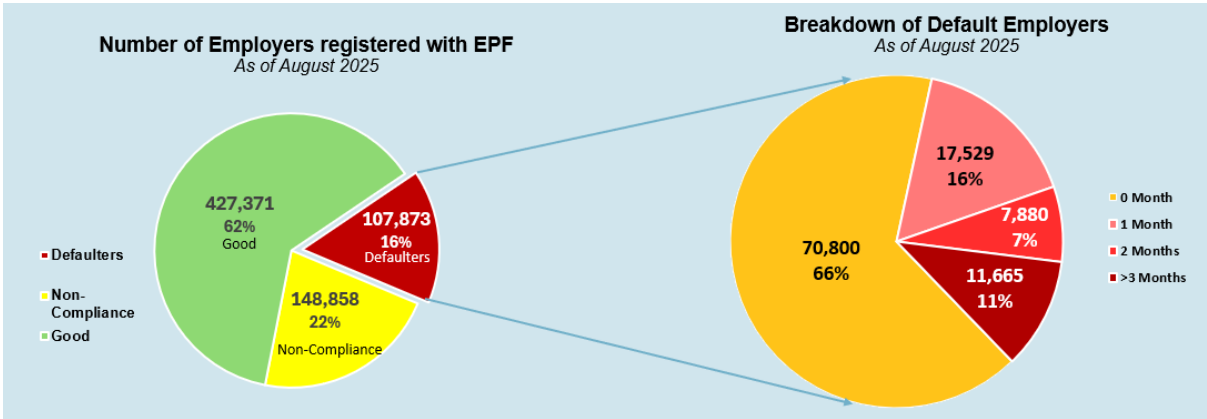
1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Overview

In accordance with the EPF Act 1991, employers are responsible for ensuring proper management of EPF contributions for every individual engaged under a contract of service or apprenticeship. This includes accurately deducting monthly contributions from employees’ salaries and remitting them to the EPF within the stipulated timeframe.

As part of EPF’s Operations, branch enforcement officers (Inspectors) will perform the **Employer Outstanding Contribution Assessment** process (*Taksiran Caruman Tertunggak*) on default employers (more than 2 months), where they will receive the salary records from the employers in various non-standard formats and through multiple channels, including email and physical documents. This assessment process is being performed within the **Enforcement Management System (EMS)**. The number of default employers is illustrated in the **Diagram 1** below:

Diagram 1 : Total Number of Employers and Breakdown of Default Employers



The current annual assessments are around 18,000 of different layouts (from defaulted employers of two months and above) as shown in **Table 1**. **Table 2** displays the annual page processed for these assessments which is estimated about 110,000 annual pages. The current process require the Inspectors to manually key-in each employee details during data entry into the EMS .EPF has identified that this manual data entry process can be automated via an **Intelligent Document Processing (IDP)** solution that has the features of Optical Character Recognition (OCR) and AI-assisted text extraction from scanned documents.

Table 1 : Total Annual Assessments

YEARS	2021		2022		2023		2024	
ITEMS	No. of Assessment	No. of Employees	No. of Assessment	No. of Employees	No. of Assessment	No. of Employees	No. of Assessment	No. of Employees
CENTRAL	6,661	107,471	7,187	106,453	7,689	127,320	9838	144,401
EAST	448	5,312	556	10,455	560	7,224	932	11,562
NORTH	1,772	29,705	1,942	21,536	1,976	24,351	2683	29,886
SABAH	280	2,421	300	4,139	258	2,724	457	4,604
SARAWAK	429	5,504	490	7,574	599	9,407	672	9,358
SOUTH	2,075	20,250	2,418	28,987	2,715	50,959	3412	63,540
TOTAL	11,665	170,663	12,893	179,143	13,797	221,984	17,994	263,352

Table 2 : Total Annual Document Pages Assessed

Year/ No. of Pages	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Grand Total No. of Pages	Average/ month No. of Pages
2021	2,365	3,279	10,356	7,572	4,027	8,409	5,045	7,163	8,670	7,818	7,074	8,690	80,469	6,706
2022	4,985	7,324	8,894	6,291	6,667	10,756	6,349	7,552	6,453	5,421	9,484	9,274	89,450	7,454
2023	7,232	6,635	8,996	4,432	8,547	7,360	5,464	9,238	7,280	7,449	9,910	5,791	88,335	7,361
2024	5,767	5,784	8,071	5,948	9,166	7,025	8,733	10,979	7,852	13,656	12,004	8,425	103,409	8,617

The purpose of this Request for Proposal (RFP) is to solicit proposals from organizations/solution providers/vendors, to conduct a fair and extensive evaluation based on criteria listed herein and select the candidate who best meets EPF's requirements to implement the IDP solution.

1.2 Structure of the RFP Document

For ease of reference, this Request for Proposal (RFP) is structured as follows:

I. Chapter 1 – Introduction

This section provides an overview of this RFP document.

II. Chapter 2 – EPF General Background

This section provides an overview of EPF as an organization.

III. Chapter 3 – Scope of RFP

This section provides the scope of the RFP and details of mandatory, functional and technical requirements.

IV. Chapter 4 – Instructions to Vendor

This section provides guidelines and outlines the instructions to the prospective Vendors in responding to the RFP and the corresponding questionnaires/requirements.

V. Chapter 5 – Communication

This section provides the EPF contact persons from whom the Vendors may seek information regarding the RFP.

VI. Appendixes

This section provides all supporting documents for the RFP including forms, questionnaires and other related documents.

1.3 Schedule of Events

The following **Table 3** is the schedule of events related to your response to this RFP:

Table 3: Schedule of Events

Activity	Tentative Date
RFP issuance to Vendors	March 2026
RFP Closing Date	April 2026
Evaluation Process	May 2026
Award of Tender	August 2026

The above dates are tentative. Vendors are advised to follow the dates indicated in the tender advertisement.

1.4 Scenario Demonstration / Proof of Concept (POC) / Presentation

After submitting the written response, the Vendor may be asked to conduct a business scenario demonstration, Proof of Concept (POC), or Presentation showcasing the key capabilities of the proposed solution. During this process, the Vendor must demonstrate the product's capabilities and features, such as what is required when defining a new document type and the user experience during uploading and visual verification. During the tender briefing, the Vendors will be provided with a set of sample documents for setting up the POC. During the POC, EPF may also provide a new sample document for the purpose of evaluating the POC extraction model.

1.5 Incurred Cost

Vendors shall acknowledge and accept that they participate in this tender at their own expense. If a bid is rejected by EPF, whether in part or in whole, the Vendor shall not be entitled for any compensation in any manner whatsoever, whether in damages or otherwise, for the expense, time and effort which the Vendor spent on such participation.

EPF is also not responsible for the cost of preparing, presenting and attending to the business scenario demonstration/POC. All expenses incurred by the Vendor shall be borne by the Vendor and will not be reimbursed. All equipment, necessary for the presentation is to be provided by the Vendor.

1.6 Correct Interpretation

It is the responsibility of the Vendor to properly interpret and understand all the requirements prior to submission of the response. During preparation of the response to the RFP, the Vendor may seek clarifications from EPF contact person via email. The contact information is detailed in Chapter 6 of the RFP.

1.7 Compliance

The Vendor must ensure that the proposal will comply with the entire requirements which is described herein. Failure to furnish all information required by this RFP or submission of the proposal that is deemed incomplete and non-conforming to the RFP requirements may result in a disqualification of the Vendor's participation.

1.8 Assurances

All Vendors are required to submit in a written undertaking as part of their formal response to this RFP:

- All our statements herein are true, correct and complete.
- No changes would be made to the composition of the consortium partners unless agreed upon by EPF
- No changes would be made to the proposed team members (personnel), inclusive of

consortium partners unless agreed upon by EPF.

1.9 Award

EPF is not obliged to award the entire package to one Vendor. EPF will have the prerogative to choose to award only certain components of the solution.

If certain components of the solution do not comply with EPF's system architecture or security policy on standardization, EPF reserves the right to request the Vendor to change such components.

EPF also has the right to award and give priority to Vendor who is MSC Malaysia status companies. Priority will also be given to products/ solution/ services from a local MSC Malaysia status company.

1.10 Penalty

EPF reserves the rights to impose penalties for late delivery of projects or non-conformance to pre-defined Service Level Agreements (SLA). Vendor should acknowledge their willingness to be subjected to this penalty clause.

Penalty for Breached SLA formula:

$$\text{Penalty} = 10\% \times (\text{annual contract value}^* \div 12 \text{ months})$$

* Annual contract value is inclusive of SST. However, in Locked Price and Out of Pocket Expenses (OPE) is excluded.

Note: If there is no annual contract value for the current year due to warranty or value is inclusive with the project/maintenance, the penalty amount for the current year will be based on the next annual contract value that is payable to supplier.

Liquidated Ascertained Damages (LAD) formula:

$$\text{LAD} = \frac{\text{Total Project Cost} \times 10\%}{\text{Duration of Project (calendar days)}}$$

Note:

- The calculation of LAD should be based on project cost (including SST or any taxes imposed by respective countries)
- The LAD amount must be at a minimum of RM 1,000.00 per calendar day of delay, i.e. if the LAD amount, when calculated based on the above formula is less than the minimum amount, the LAD amount will equal to RM1,000.00.

1.11 Taxes

Pricing should include all applicable taxes.

1.12 Validity of Proposal

Every proposal submitted will remain valid for a period of **six (6) months** from the “RFP Closing Date” as indicated in **Table 1: Schedule of Events**, or from the closing date as indicated in the official advertisement, and during such extension of the period as many afterwards separately be agreed in writing by the Vendor at the request of EPF.

2. EPF GENERAL BACKGROUND

2.1 Organization

The EPF was established on 1 October 1952 under the EPF Ordinance 1951 and it is the oldest employees provident fund operator in the world. The Ordinance has been replaced by the EPF Act 1991.

The EPF is governed by a Board comprising representatives from the government, employees, employers and professionals. There is also an investment panel that watches over EPF's investment activities. The panel comprises a Chairman, a representative of the Ministry of Finance, a representative of Bank Negara Malaysia and three experts in finance and investment.

The accumulated contributions of the members are invested in various instruments as allowed by the EPF Act 1991. The fund consisting of investments in Malaysian Government Securities, Money Market Instruments, Private Debt Securities, Loans, Equities and Properties, spanning across various countries worldwide.

2.2 Vision

We build a better retirement future for Malaysians.

2.3 Mission

Helping members achieve a comfortable retirement income.

2.4 Products and Services

EPF collects defined monthly contributions from employees through their employers. The contributions represent a certain percentage of salaried employee's income supplemented by another percentage by the employers.

EPF maintains records of contributions to monitor non-compliance. The accumulated contributions are then invested in various instruments allowed by the Act. EPF regularly advises employees on their savings via electronic channel, i.e. i-Akaun and Mobile Apps.

As permitted by the Act, members may withdraw part of their savings before retirement age. The money can be used to purchase house, pay for health treatment, pay for education or invest in unit trusts.

For more information, please visit <http://www.kwsp.gov.my>

3. PROJECT OVERVIEW

3.1 Project Background

This project aims to implement an enterprise-ready IDP platform that has OCR-capabilities assisted by AI that can extract text from different document layouts (structured, semi-structured and unstructured) and file formats including but not limited to PDF and image formats (PNG, TIFF, JPEG and BMP).

3.2 Project Objectives

The project aims to achieve the following objectives:

- a) Providing the Enforcement users with a platform that they can upload the scanned salary records in digital format (pdf or tiff) via a user interface (UI) and the solution will be able to process and extract the required metadata and afterwards provide a user interface (UI) for the user to perform visual verification and rectification of the metadata as part of the human-in-the-loop stage. The solution will also be integrated with the Enforcement Management System (EMS) and Enterprise Content Management (ECM).
- b) Integration: The solution shall be integrated with EPF applications such as ECM and EMS via REST API or Secure FTP file transfer. The EMS and ECM flat file format will be provided during the tender briefing.
- c) Enterprise features : To have an enterprise-capable platform that can cater for future use cases requiring IDP features either involving financial (e.g. invoices), legal (e.g. contracts and agreements) or operations (e.g. forms, notices) documents
- d) Interconnectivity : The readiness of the solution to be able to integrate with EPF's current systems such as Microsoft 365, SharePoint, Power Platform, SAP SuccessFactor, Ariba and S/4HANA can also be highlighted by the vendor as an advantage.

3.3 Current EPF Process

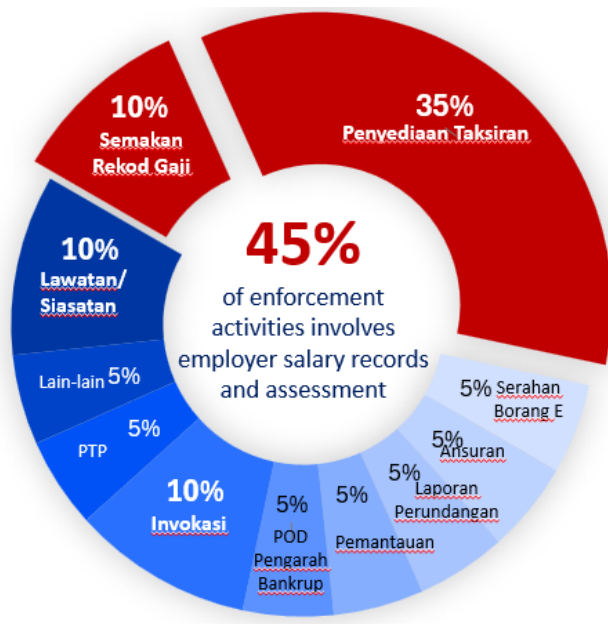
Employer Outstanding Contribution Assessment

1. Inspectors will request from the non-compliant employers for the salary records.
2. The salary records are received from the employers in various non-standard formats and either via email or physical documents.
3. The Inspectors will review the salary records and key in the data manually for each employee into the **Enforcement Management System (EMS)**. Each assessment of an employer in EMS

will start with the creation of the Form E.

4. This assessment process encompasses 45% of the Inspectors' workload as highlighted in **Diagram 2** below:

Diagram 2 Breakdown of Inspectors' Workload



Pain Points

1. Inefficient Manual Process:

- Time Inefficiency: Manual data entry of salary records and posted values is time-consuming and causes delays.
- Manual Verification Process: Salary records are verified manually through visual comparison (eyeballing), which involves checking for:
 - Type of wage/salary/payment/compensation
 - Amount liable for contribution
 - Voluntary Excess (VE) status
 - Members aged 60
 - Employee citizenship (Contribution rates are different for Malaysian and non-Malaysian employees)

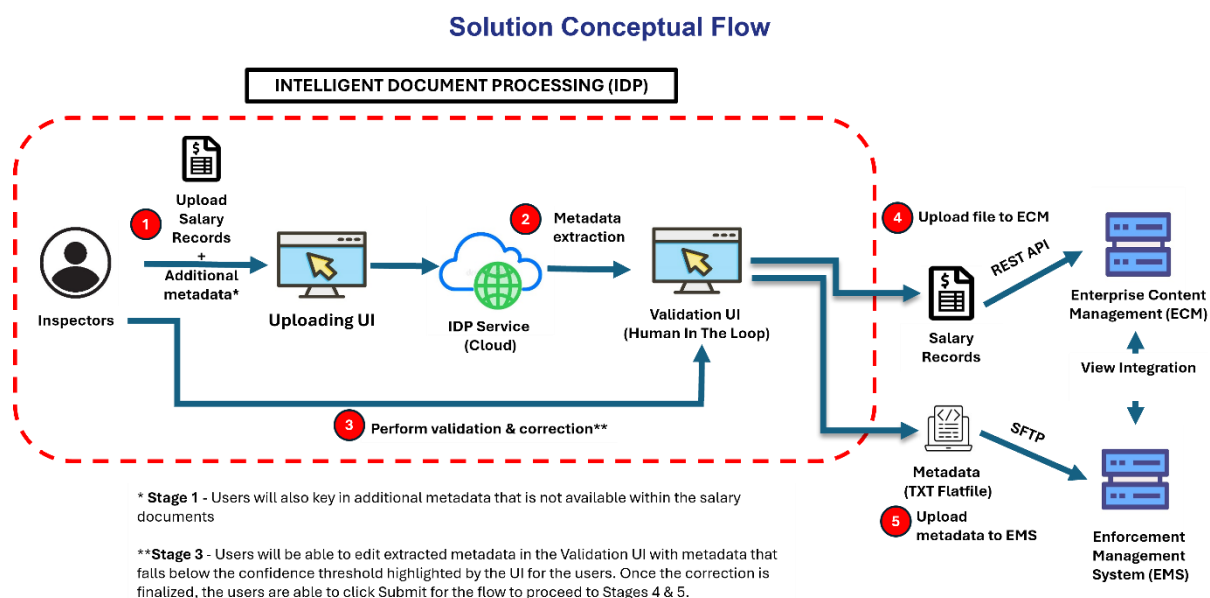
2. Inconsistent Salary Documentation: Salary records are not standardized, making verification and validation difficult.

3. Increased numbers from Non-Malaysian Citizen Employee (NMCE) - The mandatory EPF contribution for NMCE is expected to increase enforcement workload,

requiring additional monitoring and assessment of default employers

3.4 Proposed solution

Diagram 3: Proposed Solution Conceptual Flow



New assessment process

- To begin the assessment process, the Inspectors will upload the salary record via an Uploading user interface (UI) as highlighted in **Step 1 Diagram 3** above. Additional metadata such as **Employer No.**, **Assessment Start Month** and **Assessment End Month** will also need to be keyed-in by the Inspector during this stage as this data is not available within the document. If the Inspector receives the physical document, they will need to scan the documents as PDF format first before they can upload the file. The physical document scanning process is not part of this RFP scope.
- Once uploaded, the document will be processed by the IDP service for Metadata Extraction (**Step 2**). The document will not be used to train the LLM model but only for extraction.
- Below are the metadata required for extraction from the salary records:

No	Metadata	Mandatory (Yes/No)	Remarks
1	Employee Name	Yes	
2	IC/MyKad	No	Extract if available otherwise return as blank string.
3	Basic/Gross Salary Amount	Yes	
4	Allowance Amount*	No	Extract if available. Otherwise return as 0
5	Commission Amount	No	Extract if available. Otherwise return as 0
6	Bonus Amount	No	Extract if available. Otherwise return as 0

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7	Other Income Amount	No	Extract if available. Otherwise return as 0
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*For allowance amount, due to the various allowance types available, the solution should extract all allowance amounts for the selection by the user in Step 3 during Human-In-The-Loop stage.

4. For the extraction process, the solution shall cater for exception handling for scenarios such as poor-quality documents, partial extraction, corrupted images, network failure, offline continuity, re-routing/retry functions or duplicate submissions (document already processed)
5. Next stage (**Step 3**) will be the Human-in-The-Loop Validation stage by the Inspectors to confirm that the extracted metadata is correct as per the scanned image. The users will be able to view the image and metadata side-by-side and perform the necessary updates as necessary. The solution will indicate to the users the confidence percentage of the extracted metadata on field level. Metadata that require further attention by the user should be highlighted (eg. Green color for good metadata, amber color for metadata that need confirmation). Once the user is satisfied with the results, they can click Submit for the next stage.
6. **Step 4** is the next stage where the solution will upload the documents to Enterprise Content Management (ECM) either via REST API or SFTP and send the metadata in the required flatfile format to the Enforcement Management System (EMS) via SFTP. The flatfile will be processed by the EMS as pre-filled data for Form E. The rest of the assessment will continue in EMS as per the current process.
7. Any PII data should not be stored in the cloud and should only be used during processing and in-transit. Data reconciliation will be between the IDP, ECM and EMS based on non-PII data.

8. The current applications involved in this process is detailed out in **Table 3** below:

Table 3: Description of the current applications in EPF environment

No.	Applications	Description
1	Enforcement Management System (EMS)	This system is being used by the Enforcement users for the management of the employers including the function of Outstanding Contribution Employer Assessment. Currently the system has no automation and most of the new data is being keyed-in manually. The IDP proposal is expected to address the manual data entry for this system.
2	Enterprise Content Management (ECM)	ECM serves as a central document repository for members' and employers' related documents such as Registration, Withdrawal & Nomination application forms and supporting documents. The IDP proposal is expected to store the processed salary records into this system either via REST API or SFTP. The current ECM platform is using Newgen OmniDocs.
3	Secure File Transfer Protocol (SFTP) Gateway	EPF uses SFTP for the purpose of file transfer between one system to another. For external systems transfer to internal systems, there is an SFTP Gateway that will be the middleman for this communication. The IDP proposal is expected to use SFTP for the flat file transfer to EMS.
4	API Gateway	EPF uses API Gateway for the purpose of REST API calls between external systems to EPF's internal systems or vice versa. The IDP proposal is expected to use SFTP for the flat file transfer to ECM.

4. SCOPE OF RFP

4.1 Summary of Scope of Work

Vendor scope of work will cover as per table below.

Table 4: Summary of Project Scope

NO	SCOPE DESCRIPTION
1	<u>Advisory & Consultation</u> ▪ Propose the IDP Solution using the Cloud deployment that fulfills the requirement as stated in the SoW. ▪ Review and assess the EPF business requirements and proposed solution architecture and recommend best practice for EPF environment and usage. The recommendation should not only cater for the Enforcement Employer Assessment use case but also for future use cases that can benefit from the IDP technology. ▪ To propose data reconciliation method/process between the IDP solution and the EMS and ECM ▪ To assess and advise on the bandwidth requirements for EPF implementation of the solution and the integration with internal EPF systems (EMS and ECM) via API/SFTP
2	<u>Features and Services</u> Provide the IDP solution which includes the following features: 1. Ingestion & Input Management: • Supports multiple ingestion channels: • Web upload • API upload • Email ingestion • SFTP / secure drop folder • M365 / SharePoint / OneDrive integration • Batch ingestion • Bulk upload capability • Metadata tagging at ingestion • Pre-processing: • De-skew • De-noise • Image enhancement

NO	SCOPE DESCRIPTION
	• Rotation correction • Barcode / QR detection 2. AI / Extraction Capabilities: • OCR engine has multi-language support for English and Bahasa Melayu) • Handwriting recognition (when required) • Table extraction capability • Key-value extraction • Line-item extraction (eg invoices, lists, salary records) • Free text/document context understanding using LLM • Document classification (auto document type detection) • Model confidence scoring • Custom model training capability • Zero-shot / few-shot learning using LLM 3. Human-in-the-Loop (HITL) • Confidence-based routing (low confidence → human review) • Role-based validation queues • Field-level correction capability • Multi-stage approval workflow • Annotation/labeling user interface for training 4. Orchestration & Workflow • Workflow engine (rule-based routing) • Business rules engine • Exception handling workflows • Integration with RPA (Blue Prism etc.) (optional) • API/webhook triggers 5. Integration & Ecosystem Compatibility • REST API • Secure FTP • Native connectors (optional): • Microsoft 365 • SharePoint • SAP S/4HANA

NO	SCOPE DESCRIPTION
	• SAP SuccessFactors • RPA tools (Blue Prism) 6. Cloud Security • ISO 27001 / 27018 / SOC 2 • No data used for vendor model training without consent • Data encryption at rest and in transit • Customer-managed keys (CMK / BYOK) • PII masking capability (optional) • Role-based access control (RBAC) • SSO (Azure AD) • MFA support • Data retention policy configuration which can be determined by EPF 7. Operations Dashboard & Governance • Processing volume metrics (dashboard) • Accuracy metrics per document type • Model performance monitoring • Environment separation (Development, Testing and Production) • Deployment automation • Cloud Backup & disaster recovery • High availability architecture • Analytics and reporting • Audit trail of all uploaded documents for review and file reconciliation purposes 8. High-availability configuration • The solution shall have configuration backup and recovery and high-availability feature • In the event the EMS and ECM system is offline, the IDP solution shall still be accessible to the users, and the output can be resumed to the EPF systems once they are back online. • The proposed solution must provide a minimum service availability of 99.9% uptime per calendar month, excluding scheduled maintenance windows agreed in advance. Availability shall be measured end-to-end from the customer's

NO	SCOPE DESCRIPTION
	access point. The Vendor must provide documented SLA commitments and service credit mechanisms for non-compliance.
3	<u>Technical provisioning, configuration and setup</u> ▪ Provision, configure, and set up the IDP platform based on cloud SAAS model to align with EPF requirements, ensuring optimal performance and system efficiency. ▪ The technical set up shall cover Production, Development and Testing Environment. ▪ The Vendor to propose Development/Testing environment sufficient to conduct application and system integration testing, load, performance testing or any other testing required before deployment to Production
4	<u>Average Processing Time per Transaction</u> Vendor to ensure that the average processing time for a single transaction containing 10 pages with employee data starting from metadata extraction to the human-in-the-loop validation stage will take less than 3 minutes.
5	<u>Baseline Extraction Accuracy Rate</u> The solution shall have a baseline extraction accuracy rate of <u>80% or higher</u>. This accuracy threshold can be configurable, and vendor shall advise on the methods to increase the accuracy rate. The final accuracy threshold will be subject to mutual agreement between EPF and the Vendor during the project implementation.
6	<u>Integration with EPF Systems</u> Provide Integration capabilities to EPF's system as specified in Technical Requirement section in this RFP. a. Enforcement Management System (EMS). b. Enterprise Content Management (ECM). c. Microsoft Azure AD for Single-Sign On (SSO). EPF uses multi-factor authentication (MFA) using Microsoft Authenticator d. Other EPF systems via the use of either REST API or SFTP.

NO	SCOPE DESCRIPTION
7	<u>License and Man-days Requirements</u> To propose the software licensing/subscription/man-days to support: 1. 120 end-users that can perform document upload and metadata validation against image 2. 2 System Administrator that can manage and monitor the system and add/modify the document types and models 3. 150,000 annual pages to be extracted 4. Man-days to support technical issues and the in-scope maintenance requirements All software licenses and software development costs (if applicable) on Year Zero (0) shall be included as part of one-time project cost <u>Catalogue Pricing for Additional License and Man-Days</u> To propose the software licensing/subscription/tiering for the catalog items as below during the five (5) year maintenance period: 1. Additional End-users 2. Additional System Administrators 3. For additional page processing purchasing (bundle packs/package tiering) <u>Mandays for CR</u> To provide costing for man-days of Change Request (CR) effort during the five (5) year maintenance period, to be consumed on an as-needed basis. CR man-days may be used for new business use case development, document schema updates, workflow modifications, validation logic updates, and minor enhancements, excluding major system upgrades or new modules.
8	<u>Security advice and implementation approach</u> a. End to end integration security must meet EPF security requirements. b. Encryption of data communication between client devices/web and servers is required.

NO	SCOPE DESCRIPTION
	c. The solution shall comply with the latest security protocol designed to facilitate privacy and data security for communications over the Internet. The solution should comply with the EPF IT Cloud Security Baseline
9	<u>Project Management</u> a. Oversee the project from inception to completion, ensuring adherence to timeline and quality benchmarks. b. Produce the project planning for the implementation of the entire project includes providing the Project Charter, implementation strategy, communication plan, etc. c. Vendor shall manage and coordinate the Project from end to end and update the project progress to stakeholders in PWC (Project Working Community) and PSC (Project Steering Community) meeting as and when required. d. Vendor's Project Manager must be the single point of contact for EPF and the one to have an overall overview for the smooth implementation of the project. Provide all relevant professional services in commissioning the project including the change management processes, risk management and project deliverables.
10	<u>Project Duration</u> Vendor to propose the project duration period including the environment set up for Development, Testing and Production, the development of the user interface for document uploading and validation and the integration required between the IDP solution with EMS and ECM and the required testing before the system go-live. Shorter implementation timeline will be considered an advantage. The duration of the project must not be more than <u>5 months</u>, and the project warranty is six (6) months upon the sign off certificate of acceptance. The project duration also includes EPF internal processes such as the Enterprise Architecture forum and Change Approval (CAB) and Service Onboarding. Please refer to the High-Level Project Timeline as in Diagram 4: Overview of Warranty & Maintenance All works must be completed within five (5) months and must be started not

NO	SCOPE DESCRIPTION
	later than two (2) weeks from the Kick-Off Meeting.
11	<u>Change Management</u> Change Management scope shall include the following activities: • Define and identify the key stakeholders involved for the change management and project management team • Undertake Change Management activities to smoothen the acceptance of change on the new processes and tools • Facilitate the adoption of the new solution for impacted EPF employees that includes end-user and system administrator training along with providing the required training materials such as but not limited to product manuals, user guides, system administration guide and common troubleshooting guide. • The appointed vendor's Change Management (CM) team shall collaborate closely with EPF's Change Management (CM) team and comply fully with all applicable Change Management standards, methodologies, frameworks, and governance guidelines established by EPF. • The appointed vendor shall be required to produce all Change Management deliverables aligned to the above scope, which may include but are not limited to the above's activities
12	<u>Documentation</u> Provide related documentation (softcopy) for the following areas: a. Project Documentation b. Training materials c. User Guidelines d. System & Operational manuals e. Test Documentation (E.g. SIT, UAT)
13	<u>Test Execution and Management</u> a. Unit test of solution with test reports and test cases & results b. Assist and support SIT, UAT, and all other project testing phases required as part of the project and its required documentation. c. Defect management and resolution.

NO	SCOPE DESCRIPTION
	d. Perform penetration testing and performance testing as and when required by EPF security team
14	<u>Training and Communication</u> a. Provide training sessions for relevant staff members on system administration, operation and maintenance. b. To provide and manage the communication plan which could include: • Awareness sessions • User guide • Videos
15	<u>Maintenance Support & Subscription</u> a. The Vendor is required to furnish details regarding the platform's software licensing, delivery model, and system support, all of which should be encompassed within the platform subscription. b. Provide the subscription to the IDP subscription for 5 years (3 + 2). c. The Vendor is required to propose a support package for their solution that aligns with the service level of EPF for 5 years (3 + 2).
16	<u>PII Data Handling & Data Reconciliation</u> The vendor to propose on the data reconciliation process between IDP and the data/files sent to EMS and ECM. For the data reconciliation, only the non-PII details should be kept within the cloud (eg. Submission ID (auto-generated by IDP), Upload Date Time, Uploaded by User, Total Rows for submission etc) Any PII data from the salary record should not be stored or kept in the cloud and should only be used in-transit within the solution.

4.2 Mandatory Requirements

The Vendor must meet all mandatory requirements as stated in **Table 5** below:

Table 5: Mandatory Requirements

NO	TECHNICAL MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS
1.	The vendor must have a back-to-back arrangement and an active relationship with product Principal Note: Vendor must be able to provide reference/specialization letter as a proof of certified partner on their related and active competencies.
2.	The vendor must have experience of at least one (1) Intelligent Document Processing implementation / solution or related project that has been successfully implemented either in Malaysia or internationally within the past five (5) years. *Note: Vendor are required to provide the proven site for the similar project and maintenance with the details below: Project: i. Name of project ii. Company involved iii. Contact person and contact number Vendor who does not have experience in this area will be disqualified.
3	Vendor solution has certification for international security standards such as ISO 27001 and ISO 27018 and able to provide the SOC Type 2 report.
4	Vendor to provide Compliance Attestation: Principal to provide compliance certifications and attestations, confirming that data is not accessed by the Principal or external parties without consent.

4.3 Functional Requirements

The solution must meet all functional requirements as stated in **Table 6** below:

Table 6: Functional Requirements

NO	FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS
1	Document Ingestion The solution shall: • Support multi-channel ingestion: • Web upload • REST API • Email ingestion • SFTP / secure folder • M365 / SharePoint integration • Support bulk upload • Accept common formats (PDF, TIFF, JPEG, PNG, BMP, etc.) • Support metadata tagging at upload • Perform automatic pre-processing (deskew, noise removal, rotation correction) • Support document size limits suitable for enterprise use
2	Document Classification The solution shall: • Automatically classify documents into predefined document types • Support supervised training for new document types • Allow confidence scoring per classification • Route documents based on classification results • Support model versioning • Allow manual override of document type
3	Data Extraction & Understanding The solution shall: • Extract key-value pairs • Extract tabular / line-item data • Extract free-text fields • Support structured, semi-structured, and unstructured documents • Support multi-language OCR

NO	FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS
	• Provide field-level confidence scores for all extracted data elements and allow configurable threshold-based routing for human validation. • Allow custom field definitions • Support custom model training • Support LLM-based contextual extraction • Detect and mask PII (optional)
4	Human-in-the-Loop (Validation) The solution shall: • Route low-confidence documents for human review • Provide field-level correction user interface • Track user changes (audit trail) • Support multi-stage validation workflow • Capture correction data for model improvement • Provide role-based validation queues
5	Workflow & Orchestration The solution shall: • Support configurable workflow engine • Support rule-based routing • Support exception handling flows: poor quality documents, partial extraction, corrupted images, network failure, offline continuity, re-routing/retry functions, duplicate documents (already processed) • Support event-driven integration via REST API and webhook mechanisms to automatically transmit processed document data to downstream systems upon completion of workflow. • Provide status tracking per document • Allow business rules configuration without vendor coding
6	Integration The solution shall: • Provide REST APIs (fully documented) • Support webhooks • Support secure authentication (Azure AD) • Support integration with EPF email (Exchange Online)

NO	FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS
	• Provide native or configurable connectors for (optional): ○ Microsoft 365 ○ SAP S/4HANA ○ SAP SuccessFactors ○ RPA tools (e.g., Blue Prism) • Support database integration (e.g., SQL Server) • Support export in JSON / XML / CSV
7	Security & Access Control The solution shall: • Support RBAC • Support SSO (Azure AD) • Encrypt data in transit and at rest • Support customer-managed keys • Provide environment separation (Dev / UAT / Prod) • Maintain complete audit trail • Allow configurable data retention policies • Not use customer data for model training without explicit consent
8	Analytics & Monitoring The solution shall: • Provide dashboards for: ○ Processing volumes ○ Accuracy rates ○ Automation rate ○ Exception rate • Provide exportable reports • Provide SLA monitoring for document processing time
9	Scalability & Performance The system shall: • Support horizontal scalability • Provide defined SLA for processing time

NO	FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS
	- Support high-volume batch processing - Provide availability SLA (e.g., 99.9%+)
10	Metadata selection and calculation The solution should be able to provide a configurable mechanism for grouping and aggregating wage components to align with changing policies and business needs
11	Draft saving The solution shall provide draft saving feature to support seamless task continuity, ensuring that partially completed actions can be resumed efficiently at a later time.

4.4 Technical Requirements

The solution must meet all technical requirements as stated in **Table 7** below:

Table 7: Technical Requirements

NO	TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS
1	Architecture Requirements The solution shall: - Be deployed in a cloud model - Support single-tenant deployment option - Provide logically or physically isolated Dev / UAT / Prod environments - Support high availability architecture - Support horizontal auto-scaling - Provide documented system architecture diagram - Not require on-prem infrastructure unless explicitly specified
2	Infrastructure & Performance - Provide documented performance benchmarks (documents/hour) - Support concurrent processing at enterprise scale - Provide SLA for uptime (e.g., 99.9% or higher) - Support batch processing and real-time processing modes - Provide disaster recovery capability across availability zones/regions

NO	TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS																
3	Security Requirements Vendors must response to EPF Cloud Security Checklist and AI Security Checklist which is available at <u>Appendix B – EPF IT Security Checklist</u> in order to comply and meet EPF IT Security policies, guidelines and requirements. The solution shall: • Encrypt data at rest (AES-256 minimum) • Encrypt data in transit (TLS 1.2+) • Support Azure AD / SSO integration • Support RBAC • Support MFA • Provide full audit logging (user + system actions) • Provide customer-managed keys (BYOK) option • Support IP whitelisting • Not use customer data for vendor model training without explicit consent • Provide ISO 27001 / ISO 27018 / SOC 2 certifications • Provide penetration test reports – can be provided if the test has been conducted before or is scheduled periodically. If the report is not available, then the Vendor is required to perform the pen test either by engaging a 3rd party or themselves.																
4	Integration with EPF Systems The solution integrate with the EMS and ECM as below: <table><tr><th>No</th><th>System</th><th>Team</th><th>Method</th></tr><tr><td>1</td><td>EMS</td><td>EPF Internal Team</td><td>SFTP</td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td>ECM</td><td>Newgen (ECM Vendor)</td><td>REST API/SFTP</td></tr><tr><td>3</td><td>EPF API Gateway</td><td>EPF Internal Team</td><td>HTTPS</td></tr></table> For the EMS and ECM integration, the flatfile format will be provided. The solution shall integrate with Microsoft Entra Active Directory (AD), for user authentication, together with access control based on a Security Access Matrix (SAM) to provide EPF’s authentication and Single-Sign-On (SSO).	No	System	Team	Method	1	EMS	EPF Internal Team	SFTP	2	ECM	Newgen (ECM Vendor)	REST API/SFTP	3	EPF API Gateway	EPF Internal Team	HTTPS
No	System	Team	Method														
1	EMS	EPF Internal Team	SFTP														
2	ECM	Newgen (ECM Vendor)	REST API/SFTP														
3	EPF API Gateway	EPF Internal Team	HTTPS														

NO	TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS
5	Data Governance & Compliance The solution shall: • Support configurable data retention policies • Support data deletion upon request • Provide data residency options (specify required region) • Provide data segregation between tenants • Support PII masking or redaction (optional) • Comply with applicable data protection regulations (e.g., PDPA)
6	AI / Model Technical Requirements Vendors must response to EPF AI Governance Checklist which is available at <u>Appendix B1 – EPF AI Governance Checklist</u> in order to comply and meet EPF AI Governance policies, guidelines and requirements. The solution shall: • Provide model version control • Allow rollback of model versions • Provide transparency on model updates • Provide isolation between customer models • Provide testing sandbox for new model versions
7	DevOps & Deployment The solution shall: • Support version-controlled configuration management and controlled promotion of configurations across Dev, UAT, and Production environments, including rollback capability. • Provide release management process documentation • Provide change notification process • Provide maintenance window policy • Provide backup and restore procedures
8	Monitoring & Observability The solution shall: • Provide system health monitoring • Provide log export capability

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NO	TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS
	• Provide real-time alerting capability and have integration with EPF email. • Provide performance metrics export

4.5 Maintenance Scope

The vendor shall meet all maintenance scope as stated in **Table 8** below:

Table 8: Maintenance Scope

NO	Maintenance Scope															
1	System Updates and Upgrades a. Vendor shall notify EPF on any updates from principal. b. The solution shall proactively and continuously enhance to keep up and comply with the latest features/services from the principal. c. Vendor shall notify updates and plan for system upgrades to ensure the SaaS application running on the latest features, enhancements, and security patches. d. The solution shall be scalable to accommodate any increase in interactions.															
2	Technical Support a. Vendor shall offer comprehensive technical support to address user queries, troubleshoot issues, and provide solutions promptly. b. Vendor shall provide a dedicated support channel, such as a helpdesk or ticketing system, with defined response and resolution times. c. The Vendor shall comply with EPF Service Level Agreement (SLA) as below: a. System Uptime/Availability – 99.9% yearly b. The support hours = 8 hours x 5 days EPF SLA Table for Support Hours 8 x 5 <table><tr><th>Severity</th><th>1</th><th>2</th><th>3</th><th>4</th></tr><tr><td>Response Time</td><td>30 min</td><td>1 hour</td><td>1 hour</td><td>1 hour</td></tr><tr><td>Resolution Time</td><td>4 working hours</td><td>8 working hours</td><td>16 Working Hours (2 working days)</td><td>24 Working Hours (3 working days)</td></tr></table> * EPF has branches (Kedah, Kelantan and Terengganu) that operate on Sundays. Vendor shall also cater for support for these branches as well.	Severity	1	2	3	4	Response Time	30 min	1 hour	1 hour	1 hour	Resolution Time	4 working hours	8 working hours	16 Working Hours (2 working days)	24 Working Hours (3 working days)
Severity	1	2	3	4												
Response Time	30 min	1 hour	1 hour	1 hour												
Resolution Time	4 working hours	8 working hours	16 Working Hours (2 working days)	24 Working Hours (3 working days)												
3	Performance Monitoring Vendor shall implement continuous performance monitoring to identify and address any system bottlenecks, ensuring optimal application performance.															
4	Reporting															

INTELLIGENT DOCUMENT PROCESSING

NO	Maintenance Scope
	a. Vendor shall provide monthly SLA reports on system performance, support metrics, and any planned updates or maintenance activities. b. Vendor shall provide incident report in the event of service unavailability. Report must include root cause analysis and action taken to prevent and handle such incident in the future.
5	Subscription and License Management a. Vendor shall oversee license allocation (if applicable), tracking, and management to ensure compliance with the terms of the subscription. b. Vendor shall provide license and subscription to cover the software maintenance for 3 years + 2 years (optional).

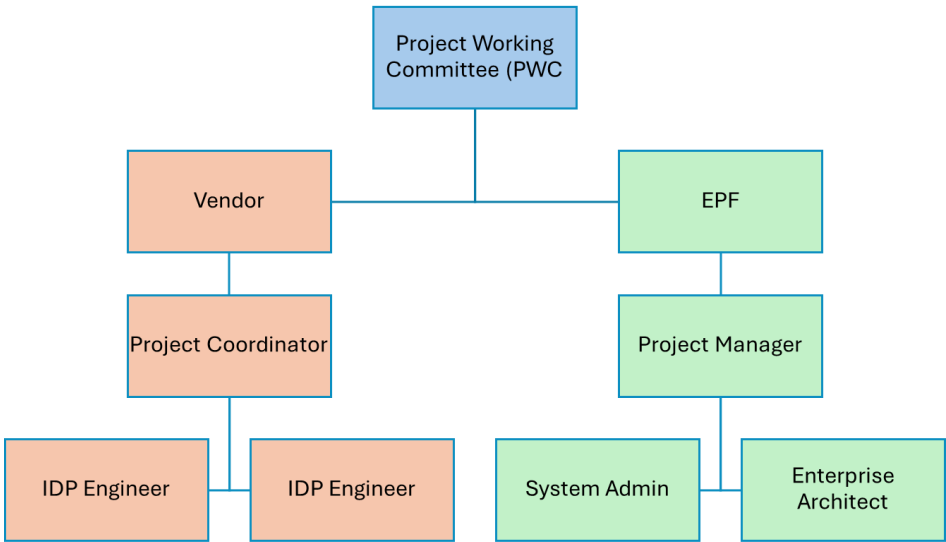
4.6 Documentation / Manual

- i. Vendors shall provide documentation for these areas. **However, only Project Charter must be provided in Vendor's proposal. Other documents can be provided by Vendor during the implementation of project:**
 - Project Charter
Document background, scope, WBS, deliverables, implementation plan/ high level & detailed timeline, training methodology, RACI matrix, risk log, communication plan, organization chart and best practices for this project.
 - Complete system & user documentation
Training materials, technical operations manual, user manual, standard operating procedures for system administrator, SLA & administration manual.
 - Manufacturer supplied documentation
- i. System software manuals
- ii. Hardware manuals (if applicable)
 - Operations manuals and documentation
 - Network diagram
 - Hardware configuration
 - Operating system configuration
 - Any other documents related to the operation of the System
 - All documentation must comply with EPF's standard format.
 - The documents and manuals become the exclusive property of EPF.
 - Project Completion Document
 - Project Closure Report (1 month upon project completion)
 - Post Implementation Review Report (3 months upon project completion)

4.7 Project Structure

The proposed structure for Project Working Committee (PWC) is as shown below:

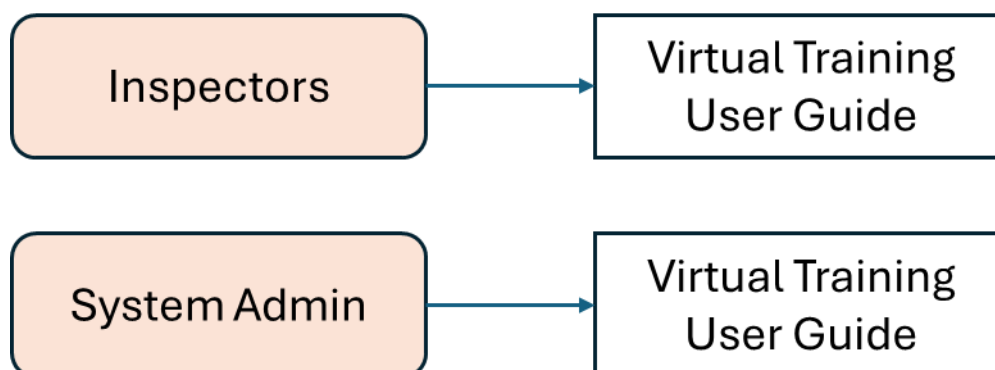
Diagram 1: Project Working Committee (PWC) Structure



Vendor should provide name, number of staff, position, skill and qualification of all team members. Vendor may propose an enhanced working structure.

4.8 Training Requirements

Diagram 2: Training Methodology



- i. The training will be focused on the Inspectors and System Administrators. The estimated number of total training participants is shown in **Table 8**:

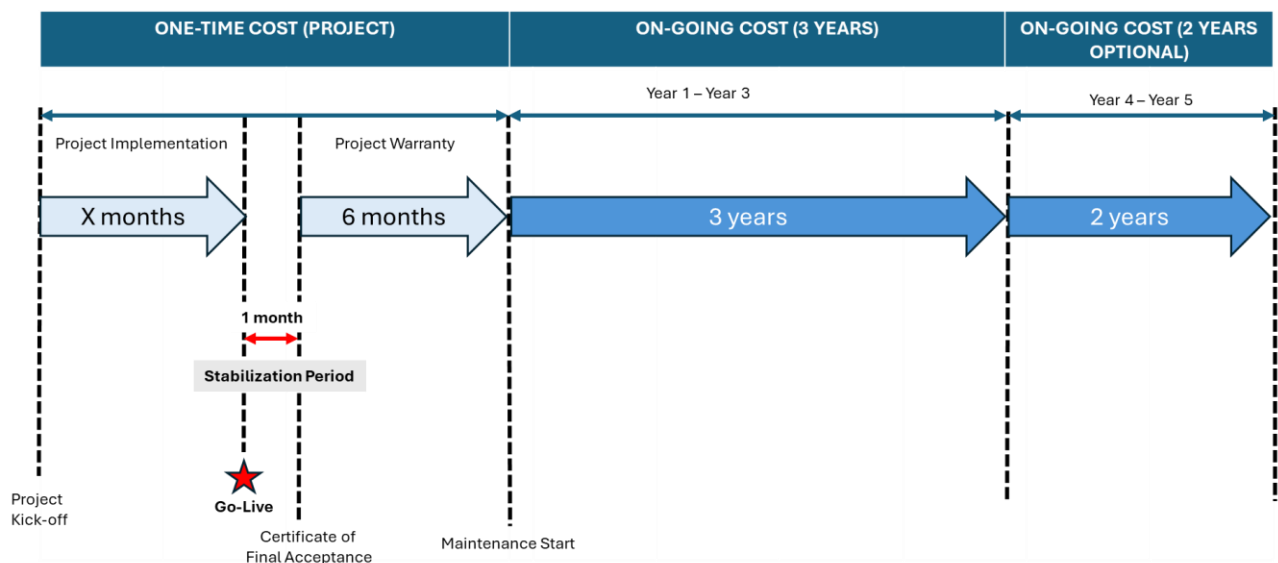
Table 8: Total of Training Participants

No	Group	Total
1	Inspectors	120
2	System Administrator	2

- ii. Vendor to propose strategy on the communication and adoption plan with users
- iii. Vendor may use EPF training facility to meet the above training requirement. Nevertheless, virtual training is acceptable, depending on the type of training.

4.9 Warranty

Diagram 4: Overview of Warranty & Maintenance



- i. The project duration will be as proposed by the Vendor however it **must not exceed more than five (5) months**.
- ii. License subscription and maintenance support must be align on its start date of year 1 upon the project warranty completion.
- iii. Project warranty should not be less than **six (6) months** and starts from the date of final acceptance (project completion.) Project warranty consists of rectification of any defect/incorrect solution or performance issues that happen within six (6) months upon project completion.
- iv. Maintenance contract will start upon project warranty end.
- v. Vendor need to state whether warranty is provided by Vendor themselves or third party e.g. principal.
- vi. Vendor must be able to produce back-to-back arrangements with the principal and the relevant third party for maintenance or support and licensing of products.
- vii. During the warranty period, Vendor should ensure the services are included to recover any application failure to operational level and also to cover any minor enhancement or bug fixes.
- viii. Please state the maintenance arrangement, support facilities and turnaround time for the support provided for the proposed solution.
- ix. Vendor is required to follow EPF Service Level Agreement (SLA) for the duration of the warranty. Vendor to propose their own SLA arrangements, but it will be subject on EPF acceptance.

4.10 Administrative Requirements

- a) Vendor must be registered with Ministry of Finance (MOF) under either of the listed *Kod Bidang*: 210103/210104/210106/210107/210108
- b) Vendor must be registered with Companies Commission of Malaysia, also known as *Suruhanjaya Syarikat Malaysia* (SSM)
- c) Vendor's contribution to the EPF as an employer is not in default.
- d) Paid up capital / shareholder's equity of at least RM 670,000.00.

4.11 Costing and Financing Options

Vendor must provide the costing and financing requirements as described in **Section 3 (Financial Responses)** of the tender document in Ariba. The costing should cover entire cost including hardware, licensing (software and hardware), maintenance, training, taxes and duties payable.

Vendor should foresee all future taxes imposed by the government inclusive levies and duties etc and to also factor in foreign exchange rates in the final contract cost.

To ensure smooth running of the solution, Vendor should propose costing for **five (5) years** (3+2) maintenance as in **Appendix C**.

4.12 Response to Questionnaires

The areas covered for functional and Vendor requirements are set out in **Questionnaires of Appendix A**.

Vendor must provide answers and supporting documents (if any) in the Questionnaires under Ariba in Section 2.

Should you require further clarification regarding any of the listed questions and requirements, please send the query to the email address as stated in this RFP (Chapter 6).

Respond to ALL questions listed by completing the columns in the questionnaires whenever applicable. Failure to provide complete and accurate responses to any of the questions listed may result in EPF being unable to fully evaluate your package.

Beyond the project scope, the Vendor may propose value added option for EPF's consideration. The value added options should be priced separately.

5. INSTRUCTIONS TO VENDOR

5.1 Response Content

Vendor should response to the Questionnaires in the Ariba System which is structured in the following separate sections:

1. Section 1: Administrative Response
2. Section 2: Technical Specifications and Proposal Response
3. Section 3: Financial Response
4. Section 4: Salient Terms
5. Section 5: Declaration

For the evaluation exercise, the completeness and conciseness of your response will directly affect the ability of the evaluation committee to determine whether your proposed software will in fact fully meet our requirements. The following guidelines should be adhered to:

5.1.1 Administrative Response

This part documents your response **to Section 1 in the Ariba System**. Submission of the required documents in **Section 1** of the RFP is essential to commence the evaluation of your proposal.

5.1.2 Technical Specifications and Proposal Response

Vendors are expected to respond to ALL questions in this section (**Section 2**) and templates listed in the Questionnaires wherever applicable. Failure to provide complete and accurate response to any of the questions listed may result in the EPF been unable to fully evaluate your proposal and lead to disqualification.

Do note that no reference should be made to any financial or cost indications in this section.

Vendor are required to upload related proposal which should be structured as follows:

Section I: Executive Summary

This section is an overview of the response and is provided by your company. The summary should contain a statement of the relative strengths of your company and a brief description of your proposed solution, clearly identifying the main benefits and time frames.

It should also include an undertaking on the following:

-
- i. All our statements herein are true, correct and complete.
 - ii. No changes would be made to the composition of the consortium partners unless agreed upon by EPF.
 - iii. No changes would be made to the proposed team members, including those of the consortium partners, unless agreed upon by EPF.

Section II: *Proposed Solution*

This section should contain the write up of the entire proposal inclusive of the software and hardware (if applicable). Please provide an overview of the technical and complete specification of the functional capabilities of your proposed solution based on the following details:

- i. System overview of the technical and functional capabilities of the proposed solution
- ii. System Architecture
- iii. System and Operational Workflow
- iv. System Limitation and Security
- v. System Backup and Contingency
- vi. System Interface Description (both user interface)
- vii. Monitoring and Reporting Tools

Section III: *Project Management*

This section should contain your proposed:

- i. Project Management Methodology (including details and high level timeline)
- ii. Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)
- iii. List of Vendors in the Consortium and their respective Roles and Responsibilities
- iv. Project Management Structure
- v. Implementation Work-Plan/Communication Program (including all stages)
- vi. Warranty & Maintenance

Vendor should be able to provide the implementation blueprint including the implementation approach, deliverables, work plan, timeline, user requirements, key milestone, implementation time, project manuals and training, warranty and support team and assistance required from EPF.

Section IV: Proposed Support and Maintenance Scope of Work

This section should contain the write up of the entire proposal inclusive of software maintenance and may consist of the following information:

- I. Service Level Agreement
- II. Support and Maintenance
- III. Scope of work
- IV. Outline description of proposed training plans, description of documentation plans and a plan for EPF technical team involvement in all project phases including customization and implementation. The training plans should include details such as:
 - Number of trainees
 - In-house or online training
 - Road map to proficiency

Section V: Vendor Information

This section should contain:

- i. Company's/Companies' (inclusive of sub-contractors) details, experience and credentials in providing the solution.
- ii. Resume of key individuals who would be working on the project and their roles.
- iii. List of installed sites where the proposed solution or similar solution has been successfully implemented – local references or/and non-local references.
- iv. Provide a letter of undertaking from original Vendors (principals) of commitment to continue support and maintenance for their software/hardware in the event the local Vendor is unable to do so.
- v. Please state all original Vendors (principals) of software and hardware proposed.
- vi. Outline description of proposed training plans, description of documentation plans and a plan for EPF technical teams' involvement in all project phases including customization and implementation. The training plans should include details such as:
 - Number of trainees
 - In-house or classroom
 - The breakdown of the cost of training should be included in the costing section.

Section VI: Response to Questionnaire

This section should contain your response to the questionnaires outlined in **Section 2 – Spesifikasi Teknikal in Ariba System**. For each question in the Vendor questionnaire, provide a detailed written response. Where applicable, attaching of screenshots is encouraged.

Section VII: Assumptions and

The Vendor should state any assumptions made in preparing the proposed solution.

Section VIII: Appendixes

This section should contain all the relevant supporting white papers, product brochures and other documents deemed necessary to support this proposal.

5.1.3 Financial Response

The following are requirements and guidance in preparing your financial response for your proposed solution. Please provide your quote in Ringgit Malaysia (RM). The quotes should also include related costs such as taxes and duties.

Section I: One-time cost requirements

This section should set out your one-time cost for your proposed solution and should be structured according to the template attached in **Appendix C** of the tender document and in Section 3 of the Ariba System. A softcopy is to be included.

The one-time cost should include:

- i. Software costs and licensing fees. Please also explain the licensing structure e.g. Enterprise, by user, by device, etc. The cost for additional licenses should be included (if applicable)
- ii. Hardware costs (if applicable). Please provide the details with cost breakdown.
- iii. Other potential costs to complete the scope of the *tender* inclusive of duties, taxes, OPE, etc.
- iv. Any imposition by the government or any regulatory authorities of goods/products and services tax ("GST") or an increase in duties and/or levies, variations in the rates, taxes and/or any increase, Vendor should make sure all the above cost to be considered as part of the project proposal.
- v. Training for administrators, developers and business users.
- vi. Implementation service cost. Please provide actual man-days and breakdown for each functionality.

- vii. Any software requiring subscription or maintenance fees to be paid up front should be included under one-time cost.
- viii. Pricing for any value-added functionality.
- ix. Cost for each item including professional services cost must be specified clearly.

Section II: *On-going cost requirements*

This section should set out your annual on-going cost for your proposed solution for the next 3 years and should be structured according to the template attached in **Appendix C** of the tender document and in Section 3 of the Ariba System. Note that the purchase of additional licenses should be within the maintenance contract.

The on-going costs may include the following one-time (depending on requirement) and recurring costs:

- i. Annual maintenance and support for all software and application (maintenance should be based on 8 hours x 5 days) as mentioned in Scope of Work.
- ii. On-going cost for optional requirement as an option.
- iii. Any licensing/subscription cost/software renewal
- iv. Any other potential costs.

Section III: *Catalogue Price (Additional License & Man-day cost)*

Vendor to provide catalogue price for **additional license purchase** based on the listing provided & **man-day cost for any professional services** & support outside the tender scope (as and when required by EPF). The catalogue price will be locked throughout the contract period and should be structured according to the template attached in **Appendix C**

Section IV: *Assumption*

The Vendor is to state all assumptions made in deriving the cost.

Vendor is to bear all pandemic related expenses, for example, COVID 19 related cost for swab tests, quarantine/hotel costs, medical costs etc. The cost is NOT to be charged to EPF.

5.1.4 Salient Terms (Contract Terms and Conditions)

- i. This Section is a **MANDATORY** section for the Vendor to response. The response given by the Vendor in this Section shall become binding upon the Vendor.
- ii. In the event the response given is not satisfactory to EPF, the Vendor shall provide clarification and justification for EPF's consideration.

-
- iii. Upon acceptance by EPF under paragraph 5.1.4 (i) to all the response provided by the Vendor in this Section, the Vendor agrees these terms shall be incorporated in the contract documentation.

5.1.5 Contract Schedules

- i. The Vendor is required to fill in the schedules listed in **Appendix D** (Contract Schedules) in accordance to the requirement under this RFP. The Vendor agrees that the Schedules including any amendments there to shall form as part of the contract documentation entered, should the Vendor be awarded for this tender/quotation.
- ii. EPF shall have the rights to amend the Schedules and/or at the request of EPF, the Vendor shall be obliged to amend/update the Schedules in accordance to EPF requirements

6. COMMUNICATION

All responses or enquiries must be in writing or via e-mails to mdp_procurement@epf.gov.my.

APPENDICES

1. Appendix A – Questionnaires
2. Appendix B – EPF IT Security Checklist (Cloud Security and AI Security)
3. Appendix B1 – EPF AI Governance Checklist
4. Appendix C – Financial Template
5. Appendix D – Contract Schedules